

Kohsar University Murree (KUM) – ORIC Intellectual Property (IP) and Consultancy Policy

1. Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to promote innovation, protect intellectual property rights, facilitate the commercialization of research outcomes, and encourage collaboration with industry and external organizations. The policy also establishes guidelines for consultancy activities undertaken by faculty members to ensure that such engagements support the university's mission while maintaining academic responsibilities.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all full-time and part-time faculty members, researchers, staff, students involved in research activities, and visiting scholars or collaborators using university resources. The policy covers intellectual property generated through research, consultancy, innovation, and other scholarly activities conducted under the auspices of the university.

3. Definition of Intellectual Property

Intellectual Property (IP) includes but is not limited to patents, copyrights, trademarks, industrial designs, plant varieties, software and databases, research data and technical know-how, and innovative processes, prototypes, and technologies. Any IP created using university resources or through university-supported research activities shall be governed by this policy.

4. Ownership of Intellectual Property

Intellectual property developed by faculty, researchers, or students using university facilities, funding, or resources shall generally be owned by the university. Where IP is developed in collaboration with external partners, ownership shall be determined through formal agreements executed prior to the commencement of the project. In cases where research is funded by external agencies, the terms of the funding agreement will determine IP ownership. The university recognizes and acknowledges the contributions of inventors and creators and appropriate recognition and benefits shall be provided according to this policy.

5. Disclosure of Intellectual Property

All inventors must disclose any potentially patentable or commercially valuable intellectual property to the Office of Research, Innovation and Commercialization (ORIC) through a formal disclosure form before any public disclosure or publication. ORIC shall evaluate the commercial potential of the disclosed intellectual property and advise the university on protection strategies including patent filing and commercialization pathways.

6. Protection and Commercialization

ORIC shall facilitate the protection and commercialization of intellectual property through patent filing and protection, licensing agreements, industry partnerships, technology transfer arrangements, and startup or spin-off company development. The university may enter into agreements with industry partners for commercialization of intellectual property while safeguarding the rights of inventors.

7. Revenue Sharing from Intellectual Property

Income generated from commercialization of intellectual property shall be shared between the inventors and the university in accordance with university regulations and standard practices followed by leading universities. Revenue distribution shall recognize the contribution of inventors while supporting further research and innovation activities within the university.

8. Consultancy Policy

Consultancy refers to professional services, expert advice, technical assistance, or research-based solutions provided by faculty members or researchers to external organizations, government bodies, or industry.

8.1 Approval Requirements

All consultancy engagements must receive prior approval through the following process: approval from the Head of Department (HoD), review and endorsement by the Office of Research, Innovation and Commercialization (ORIC), and final approval from the Vice Chancellor. No consultancy activity may be undertaken without completion of this approval process.

8.2 Academic Responsibilities

Consultancy activities must not interfere with the primary academic responsibilities of faculty members including teaching duties, research commitments, student supervision, and administrative responsibilities.

8.3 Use of University Resources

If consultancy activities require the use of university laboratories, equipment, facilities, staff support, or other institutional resources, such use must be formally approved and appropriately accounted for.

8.4 Revenue Sharing from Consultancy

Case 1: Consultancy without use of university facilities, No sharing required

Case 2: Consultancy involving university facilities – Consultant/Faculty Member: 75%, University: 25%. The university share will support maintenance of facilities, research development, and innovation activities.

9. Conflict of Interest

Faculty members must disclose any potential conflicts of interest related to consultancy or intellectual property activities. The university reserves the right to review and regulate such engagements to ensure transparency and institutional integrity.

10. Confidentiality

All parties involved in consultancy or intellectual property agreements must maintain confidentiality regarding proprietary information, research data, and commercial agreements unless disclosure is authorized.

11. Role of ORIC

The Office of Research, Innovation and Commercialization shall manage intellectual property disclosures, facilitate patent filing and protection, review consultancy proposals, maintain records of consultancy agreements, and support industry engagement and commercialization activities.

12. Policy Review

This policy shall be reviewed periodically to ensure alignment with national regulations, Higher Education Commission (HEC) guidelines, and international best practices in research commercialization and intellectual property management.